Dipankar **Srirag**

Ph.D. Candidate, University of New South Wales

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My research develops language technologies for linguistically diverse users, from models that stay robust across language varieties to Emergency Department triage tools that serve patients regardless of the language they speak. I have published 13 papers, including 4 first-author papers at CORE A/A* conferences. I am a course administrator for COMP6713 Natural Language Processing and teach three other courses across two universities. I also mentored two undergraduate students through the Taste of Research program.

Education

University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia
Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering **Jun 2025 – Present**
- Advisors: Dr. Aditya Joshi, Dr. Padmanesan Narasimhan, Prof. Salil Kanhere.
- Funded by the NHMRC Ideas Grant.

University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia
Master of Information Technology (with Excellence), WAM: 81.4 **Sep 2022 – Sep 2024**
- Advisor: Dr. Aditya Joshi.
- Thesis: *Dialect Robustness of Language Models in Game-Playing Conversations.*

Manipal Institute of Technology, Manipal, India
B.Tech. in Information Technology, GPA: 8.3 **Jul 2018 – Jul 2022**

Publications

LLMs Anchor on Chief Complaint and Fail to Integrate Evidence in Sequential Clinical Triage
Dipankar Srirag, H. Zhao, A. Kumar, E. Hopper, M. Dalton, Q. D. Nguyen, A. Joshi, S. Kanhere, P. Narasimhan
Under review

From Triage to Discharge: A Survey of NLP Tasks, Methods, and Open Challenges in the Emergency Department
Dipankar Srirag, A. Joshi, S. Kanhere, P. Narasimhan
Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing

DiaLLM: An Investigation into the Robustness-Generation Gap in English Dialect Adaptation
J. Painter, **Dipankar Srirag**, A. Kappiyath, D. Kanojia, A. Joshi, L. Yin
Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing

Scaled Autoregressive Projection Steering (SAPS): Token-level Steering to Induce Sarcasm and Humblebrag in Text
S. Naganna, R. S. Chowdhury, **Dipankar Srirag**, A. Joshi
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2026

Retell, Reward, Repeat: Reinforcement Learning for Narrative Theory-Informed Story Retelling
D. Y. Liu, X. Muston, **Dipankar Srirag**, A. Joshi, S. Sequoiah-Grayson
Proceedings of the 19th International Natural Language Generation Conference

TriageSim: A Conversational Emergency Triage Simulation Framework from Structured Electronic Health Records
Dipankar Srirag, Q. D. Nguyen, A. Joshi, P. Narasimhan, S. Kanhere
Proceedings of Interspeech 2026

A Taxonomy-Driven Case Study of Australian Web Resources Against Technology-Facilitated Abuse
Dipankar Srirag, X. Cen, R. Masood, A. Joshi
Proceedings of the 31st Australasian Conference on Information Security and Privacy

BESSTIE: A Benchmark for Sentiment and Sarcasm Classification for Varieties of English
Dipankar Srirag, A. Joshi, J. Painter, D. Kanojia
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2025

Predicting the Target Word of Game-playing Conversations using a Low-Rank Dialect Adapter for Decoder Models
Dipankar Srirag, A. Joshi, J. Eisenstein
Proceedings of the 2025 Conference of the Nations of the Americas Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics

PAREDA: A Multi-Accent Speech Dataset of Natural Language Processing Research Discussions
S. Jin, **Dipankar Srirag**, A. Joshi
SPEAKABLE Workshop, co-located with LREC 2026

Far Out: Evaluating Language Models on Slang in Australian and Indian English
D. K. Dilsiz, **Dipankar Srirag**, A. Joshi
13th Workshop on NLP for Similar Languages, Varieties and Dialects (VarDial), co-located with EACL 2026

Nek Minit: Harnessing Pragmatic Metacognitive Prompting for Explainable Sarcasm Detection of Australian and Indian English
I. Singh*, **Dipankar Srirag***, A. Joshi
23rd Annual Workshop of the Australasian Language Technology Association (ALTA 2025), **Best Paper Honorable Mention**

Evaluating Dialect Robustness of Language Models via Conversation Understanding
Dipankar Srirag, N. R. Sahoo, A. Joshi
Second Workshop on Scaling Up Multilingual and Multi-Cultural Evaluation (SUMEval), co-located with COLING 2025

Awards and Achievements

- **Best Paper Honorable Mention**, ALTA 2025 — Dec 2025
- **UNSW TFS Scholarship**, Ph.D. — Jun 2025
- **UNSW Award of Excellence**, Master of Information Technology — Sep 2024

Research Experience

University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia
Research Officer — **May 2024 – May 2025**

- Developed BESSTIE, a benchmark for sentiment and sarcasm classification for varieties of English.
- Improved sarcasm explanation generation for small language models with pragmatic metacognitive reasoning methods.
- Evaluated machine-translated school communications for low-resource languages, funded by the NSW Department of Education.

Invited Talks

Emergency Department: A Real-World Edge Case for Clinical NLP — Nov 2026

- *39th Australasian Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AJCAI 2026)*

Sharing the Responsibility for the Ethical and Effective Use of AI in Providing Access to Non-English Speakers to Health Services in Emergency Departments — Nov 2026

- *39th AUSIT National Conference*

Building Resources and Evaluations for Language Varieties — Nov 2024

- *2nd UNSW AI Symposium*

Teaching

University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia
Casual Academic — **May 2024 – Present**

- **Course Admin:** COMP6713 Natural Language Processing. Manage tutors, design and grade tutorials and assignments.
- **Tutor:** COMP9444 Neural Networks and Deep Learning, and COMP9024 Data Structures and Algorithms.

University of Technology Sydney, Sydney, Australia
Casual Academic — **Feb 2026 – Jun 2026**

- **Tutor:** 48230 Introduction to Engineering Projects.

Mentorship

Quang Minh Pham, Undergraduate Student, UNSW Sydney — 2026

- Project: *Simultaneous Text-to-Text Translation using Large Language Models*

Ishmanbir Singh, Undergraduate Student, UNSW Sydney — 2025

- Project: *Explainable Sarcasm Detection of Australian and Indian English*

Service and Community

- **Co-organiser**, ALTA 2026 Shared Task on Sentiment and Sarcasm in Australian and British English — 2026
- **Reviewer**, ACL Rolling Review, NeurIPS 2026, WWW 2025, C3NLP@NAACL 2025, ALTA 2025 — 2025 – Present
- **Volunteer**, EMNLP 2026 — 2026
- **Director of Projects**, UNSW AI Society — 2026